

CONTENTS & VALUABLES COVERAGE GUIDE

HomeShield Insurance Group | 2025 Edition | Standard & Comprehensive Plans

UNDERSTANDING YOUR CONTENTS SUM INSURED

Calculating the Right Sum Insured

Your contents sum insured must reflect the total cost to replace ALL your household belongings and personal possessions at current new prices (new-for-old basis). It is one of the most commonly underestimated figures in home insurance.

HOW TO CALCULATE: Go room by room. For each room, list every item and its current replacement cost (not what you paid; not current second-hand value — what it would cost to buy new today).

COMMON ROOMS AND ITEMS TO INCLUDE: Living Room: Sofas, chairs, TV, media equipment, carpets, curtains, ornaments, books, lamps. Bedroom: Beds, mattresses, wardrobes, clothing (total replacement value), bedding, jewellery, watches, handbags. Kitchen: White goods (fridge, washing machine, dishwasher), cookware, small appliances, crockery, cutlery. Home Office: Computer, printer, office furniture, work equipment. Garage / Outbuildings: Tools, lawn mower, bicycles, sports equipment.

COMMON MISTAKE: Many policyholders forget to include: clothing (often worth £3,000–£8,000 for a typical family), children's toys and equipment, food and drink, garden furniture and equipment, and recently purchased high-value items.

SINGLE ARTICLE LIMITS AND SCHEDULED ITEMS

Single Article Limit Explained

The single article limit is the MAXIMUM HomeShield will pay for any single item or pair/set of items, unless that item is specifically listed (scheduled) on your policy.

Standard Cover: £1,500 per item Comprehensive Cover: £3,000 per item

EXAMPLE: You have a diamond ring worth £8,000. Your policy has a £3,000 single article limit. If it is not scheduled, HomeShield will pay only £3,000 for its loss — not £8,000. To be covered for the full £8,000, it must be specifically listed with a professional valuation.

PAIRS AND SETS: If one item from a pair or matching set (e.g., a pair of earrings) is lost, HomeShield will not pay for the full set — only the proportionate value of the lost item. Consider this when scheduling matching sets.

How to Schedule High-Value Items

Step 1: Identify all items where the replacement value exceeds the single article limit. Step 2: Obtain a professional valuation: For jewellery and watches > £3,000: a valuation from a RICS-registered jewellery valuer, dated within 3 years. For artworks and antiques: a valuation from an authorised dealer or auction house, dated within 5 years. For collectibles: specialist appraisal from an accredited appraiser. Step 3: Contact HomeShield to add the item as a scheduled item. Provide description, value, and supporting valuation. An additional premium applies for scheduled items. Step 4: Review scheduled items annually and update valuations as required.

AWAY FROM HOME COVER (Comprehensive Plan)

Coverage When Belongings Leave the Home

Comprehensive Cover includes automatic cover for personal belongings taken outside the home, anywhere in the UK or worldwide (up to 60 days per trip abroad).

COVERED AWAY FROM HOME: Clothing, jewellery, and personal effects up to £5,000 per claim. Mobile phones (up to £800 per phone). Laptops (up to single article limit). Cameras and photographic equipment. Sports equipment.

EXCLUDED AWAY FROM HOME: Motor vehicles and accessories. Tools used for business. Any item not included in the home contents cover. Items left unattended in a motor vehicle overnight.

MOTOR VEHICLE THEFT: Contents stolen from a motor vehicle are covered (up to £1,500 per event) PROVIDED the vehicle was locked and the items were stored in the boot or concealed from view. Items visible on the passenger seat are NOT covered.

ACCIDENTAL DAMAGE COVER

What Accidental Damage Covers

Accidental damage (AD) cover pays for sudden, unexpected damage that is not caused by an insured peril (fire, flood, theft, etc.) and is not the result of wear and tear.

COMPREHENSIVE COVER: Accidental damage is automatically included for both buildings and contents.

STANDARD COVER: Accidental damage is available as a paid add-on (additional premium applies).

EXAMPLES OF COVERED ACCIDENTAL DAMAGE (Comprehensive): - Red wine spilt on a carpet - A child putting a toy through a TV screen - Accidentally drilling through a hidden pipe - Knocking a vase off a shelf and breaking it - Accidentally breaking a window from inside

EXAMPLES NOT COVERED BY ACCIDENTAL DAMAGE: - Damage caused by a pet chewing or scratching - Damage resulting from DIY work in progress - Items that stop working due to mechanical or electrical failure - Scratches and dents caused by normal use - Damage caused by a tradesperson while carrying out work

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